

BLUES ON BROAD BEACH EDIT

Travel Radio Australia and this month we're in Broad Beach on the Gold Coast and we're right in the middle of one of the most fantastic festivals that happens on the Gold Coast ever. It's the iconic Blues on Broad Beach festival and I have the show director Mark Duckworth here with me. Mark, welcome to the program.

Thanks so much for having me. Now Mark, this show has been going for a long time. Can you tell us about a bit of the background of the show? Yeah, absolutely.

So look, the event started 24 years ago. It was sort of put in place in the middle of the Broad Beach precinct. I think in what was then kind of the off-season, so there was a lot of accommodation houses, the weather was cooling down and they thought how can we stimulate the economy a little bit and what can we do.

So the idea was formed to do a Blues festival. Back in those days I think the first one had maybe about three to five thousand people attend it. We now see 160,000 people over four days here for the event and look, it just goes from strength to strength and you know there's restaurants and bars and hotels and everyone kind of gets involved as a community to help us put this, to be quite frank, like a monster of event on in the city of the Gold Coast.

Now here in Broad Beach it's pretty much free. You can walk around and there's a ton of stages. Tell us about the stages you have.

Yeah, so we set up in the streets, we close down some roads and we put some stages in the streets, we take over some of the parks and then our venues, our coffee shops, you know you can walk into a restaurant that doesn't do music all year and then one one weekend a year they'll have bands on in there. Pretty much over four blocks, anywhere you turn you're gonna hear music. In fact where we caught up was just out the front of the piano bar which is where we get to the honky tonk piano players to just come and sort of play their music in a cool space right in the middle of the mall.

There's giant concert stages in Karlor Parkway, you know we see big international artists this year with Eli Paperboy Reed and Eric Gales from Memphis, like they'll be taken to the stage there later today and Salmonella Dub from New Zealand and then the Cruel Sea later tonight. So you know we can do really big sort of world-class performers and then we can accommodate you know really cool emerging blues piano players as well. We sort of try and do everything.

Now tell us about some of the artists lineup you have coming in for this year. Yeah, okay, so look Vicar and Linda came in this year, Diesel, Salmonella Dub, Eric Gales. Sunday afternoon we have Jimmy Barnes performing his iconic Soul Deep album.

He'll be supported by Poki Lafarge from the USA as well as The Bad Loves. You know the Bondi

cigars are here. Man the list goes on there's probably 70 odd acts playing around the festival for the whole four days yeah.

That's an incredible lineup and I suppose a lot of these artists really compete to be at the Blues onboard Beach. They're really keen about it. Yeah, look we've managed to grow quite a good reputation you know probably over the last ten years where we've been able to get some international artists here, show them how professional the setup is, what they're walking into and then and then that that kind of continues to flow on and other artists will hear about it other booking agents will hear about the event and you know we've been really lucky.

We've seen like you know Eric Burden and the Animals, Robert Cray, Robin Ford, Melissa Etheridge, Bonnie Tyler you know they've all been here now and and to be able to have a resume like that kind of makes my life easier to book the year after. And Mark Duckworth the show director here at Blues on Broad Beach. A bit about your background you've been I've known you for many many years back to the 80s and 90s you've been a Gold Coast boy for all that time.

This must be very satisfying for you. It absolutely is and to be able to put music on and show I guess the power of music in a city that I grew up in and give an opportunity to younger and emerging musicians you know we try and do 25% local with our music and it's a really lovely feeling to have a city that supports this kind of event and so people like myself can stick around and work in the entertainment industry on the Gold Coast. And your entertainment background did you start off in music yourself? I started off as a musical theatre singer and then dabbled in a little bit of opera decided I hated all that and and kind of joined a punk band for a few years and then got into recording and performing and somewhere along the way and I'm not really sure where it was I started bringing the lights to the show and then the PA and then maybe a couple of extra trucks or the portable toilet and before I knew it I was kind of an event planner.

So you were like the glorified roadie which I suppose you are still these days. 100% yeah yeah you can't take the roadie out of the void. That's right well Mark Blues on Broad Beach is a tremendous event we'd highly recommend it to anyone who's planning a trip to the Gold Coast.

Tell us the dates that it's happening every year. So it always happens in the third full weekend in May so this year we're 15 to 18 next year up the top of my head we're going to be 14 through 17 of May so yeah anyone who's thinking about coming come on down you won't regret it. How can people find out more about Blues on Broad Beach online? So yeah just go to bluesonbroadbeach.com and all the information you needs there and a whole bunch of vision and videos that will help you see what the whole thing's about.

Mark Duckworth show director Blues on Broad Beach thank you very much for being part of Travel Radio Australia. Thanks so much Jeff. Thank you so much.

Travel Radio Australia we are backstage at the Magnificent Blues on Broad Beach and I have with me Kathleen Halloran. What a set Kathleen. Thank you I'm still catching my breath I've

literally just walked off stage yeah what a dream.

It and the crowd went absolutely ballistic here at Blues on Broad Beach. They were incredible I just I thrive off them I feed off the crowd so much so when they're on I'm on. Now tell us a bit about yourself I know you're a Geelong girl and I was reading about you at Cranland School and and how you were really loving the teachers there and you you just hung out in the music room basically.

That's true I did I think I was a bit of a misfit but I found my place in the music department yeah from the start of high school until right through and University I was just I hung out in the music room and stayed clear of drama and stayed free of everything else distractions. Now when you were 20 you caught up with the iconic Kate Sobrano in Melbourne and tell us a bit about that. How long have you got? I'll paraphrase it so I met her on it on my first big gig coming out as a 20 year old and she was a guest artist and I was in a house band and we connected instantly like I've had so many of these moments where you just connect with someone it's spiritual and you know that they're gonna be a big part of your life and we became fast friends we're now best friends and I get to have been touring with her for six years and I've got so much to thank her for and just more than anyone would ever know to influence she's had on me and still does so an absolute blessing to have connected with her.

Now you tell us about the band you're playing with at the moment. I've been lucky enough to have Clayton Dolly with us this weekend he's from Sydney so it's a massive special treat and he's just phenomenal and he takes me into another space I often get sick of myself but when I play with someone like him I just I'm reborn and I definitely felt that today and I've got Jonathan Zion on bass who's the most incredible bass player who's kind of can't do it without him now he's such an integral part of my band and the incredible Darren Froud on drums. Oh the drummer was just insane it was just non-stop they just bring it they're just flawless.

It's just awesome and what are your plans for the future you're touring Australia and your plans for overseas what's going on? Yeah I come busting to get overseas I'm just hopefully next year the end of next year I'll get to get over to Europe but yeah I'm busting to go but lots of Australia all year long I'll go anywhere I'll get in my car and I'll drive anywhere to play yeah. Tell us some of the gigs you've got coming up you've got a full year coming up I suppose. I'm about to hit the road with Kate actually so we're doing a tour all around the country with her Australian made tour which is an ode to her Australian made tour the famous tour in the 80s that she was a part of and we're playing a lot of Australian classics and her Australian classics as well and we can find the dates for that on katesabrano.com Brilliant and how do people find you online? Yeah Instagram Kathleen Huller and music and Kathleenhuller.com you can find me.

Kathleen thanks so much straight off the stage brilliant set thanks for being with us on Travel Radio Australia. Thank you for having me. Travel Radio Australia we're on the Gold Coast and we have two legendary musicians here from the blues world we have the magnificent Dom

Turner and Sumpine Barnes who actually play together and welcome to the program guys thank you very much.

Yeah thanks I'm great and I'm happy to be here. It's fantastic to have you in Australia for Blues on Broadbeach first of all Dom you're such a legendary guy in the Australian blues scene you're a golden boy made good and you've got on to be one of the biggest guys in blues. I don't even know what to say to that one but yeah look I mean I have been playing blues been fortunate enough to be able to play blues for most of my life it's been a bit of a real life's work and I get to meet and work with some incredible people and right here at the Blues on Broadbeach this weekend it's with the incredible Sumpine Barnes from New Orleans and we're good friends but it's the first time that we've actually done like a little tour together so we're really excited about it and really excited about being able to perform for audiences here and get them to kind of get a taste of our music and and sort of see what we you know when we put our heads together what we come up with you know.

Sumpine welcome to Australia what's your impression so far of Blues on Broadbeach you're gonna be play soon. I'll tell you what we're right here on the beach and it is it's a wonderful thing I'm totally impressed by how well it's been organized first of all and all the folks that have put it together and just a great selection of music that I'm getting a chance to hear and experience really you know it's a first flight top class festival that's and there are lots of them out in the world I played a lot of them but this is really special just to seen itself been right here on the beach on the Gold Coast kind of hard to beat loving the birds coming in the roost in the evening along with all that music you know music that we've been able to put together with Dom and the fellas which I'm looking forward to playing to again it's this is a really nice dream to to be here at the time the weather's is great also so just thrilled to be a part of it and pumped up. Now your background I've been reading a bit about you you were an ex NFL player in America and you've done a whole bunch of different stuff and it's given you a tremendous background for that your musical career which you now do all over the world.

Yeah I do and I've been fortunate and lucky to be able to you know have some little dreams as a child take my music out into the world and you know playing probably 64 or five different countries around the world and and continue to love it and just be a blues messenger you know and the different styles of music that play but everything is based off of blues that I play and that was like a firm idea in my head when I was maybe 18 years old was that I was gonna start you know just playing the music that I grew up with and try and do it in a serious way and you know somehow become a professional musician so yeah I mean I've been lucky enough to do it and then manage myself in a band for a bunch of years yeah someday I'm gonna get an actual card you know business card and everything and I haven't done it yet I'm working on a website I've never done those things but I learned to I took some advice from really from Willie Dixon and he was saying that if you he was telling me this when I was 23 years old he said that you're like you're in a rare place to to be able to go out and do this and word of mouth is gonna get you

around the world to go out and play music if people hear you and you handle a business part of it like when you get on the stage and do what you're supposed to do or wherever it is just keep it real and and that'll be the thing that like be your calling card you don't have to worry about a card this way and that like they're gonna find you if you you know so I took that to heart. Dom, Backsliders it's a fantastic band and you're in with some magnificent Australian artists and I was reading about one of the guys from Midnight Oil that you're playing with so tell us about that. Rob Hurst who is basically Backsliders is really me and Rob Hurst it's kind of a duo augmented with I'm a harmonica player but yeah Rob has been in the band Rob is from Midnight Oil the drummer from Midnight Oil and he's been with the well now got over 25 years I think now he's been in the band so he's not the new boy anymore actually because we have we have a young harmonica player Joe Glover as well he's the new guy you know but yeah so Rob has been in the band for and actually we're the business partners now you know or have been since he joined in 25 years ago or whatever it is so yeah it's been it's been a great ride and yeah I mean we love working together creating music together and again that's that's one of those things that because you know people know Midnight Oil as being a rock band you know but what they don't know is that actually Rob started out as a jazz drummer in high school and he draws on a lot of jazz influences and what he does and that's creeps into what we do particularly kind of the military side of jazz you know which is prevalent in New Orleans zydeco and also with North Mississippi hill country fife and drum music so he's drawing on a lot of those things so you think okay is this guy just gonna be a rock guy no no there's more to it than that you know so that's great I just love working with Rob it's fantastic and we want to highlight your band angry tradies too which is a fantastic outlet the angry tradesman yeah angry tradesman yeah that's good the angry tradesman yeah you know it's still there we haven't done any gigs for a long time so that's also as me with Rob Hurst on drums and Martin Rotsi also at Midnight Oil on guitar it's a two guitar drum band quite a grungy outfit everything's original that we do almost everything is original in that sort of thing but yeah that's a great thing we haven't done anything for a while but yeah we should get back and do something with it well guys I know you're limited to time because you're just setting up to go on stage and some pine barns and on Turner thank you so much for being on Travel Radio Australia and our around Australia audience on our 70 plus radio stations and it's great to have you here on the Gold Coast for Blues on Broadbeats yeah thank you so much for having us and thrilled to be here I'm gonna decide if I'm going back but I'm going back gotta go home wash some clothes actually I've been jumping around but no it's a thrill to be here with with Dom and to be on the Travel Radio in Australia so thank you thanks so much guys for your time thanks a lot Jeff great to be on Travel Radio thanks again